

FESTIVAL

Laughing all the WAY

It's time for some good old-fashioned laughter at the Ranga Shankara annual festival in Bangalore this year. On offer are all-time favourites Molière, Neil Simon, Murakami, Calvino and Dario Fo. In a quest to bring back the good old days of the laughter festivals, the theatre will host a Hasya Kavi Sammelan in Kannada and Hindi. The ancillary activities include a theatre and arts appreciation workshop with cultural commentator Sadanand Menon. This year, the festival brings a varied mix of English and regional plays. *Madime*, directed by Vijay Kumar Kodialbail in Tulu, comes from Mangalore while *Olakh Naa Paalakh* in Marathi is directed by Mangesh Kadam from Mumbai. *Vakra*, directed by Mandya Ramesh, is the Kannada version of Molière's *Le Misanthrope* and *Aatankavadiya Aakasmika Saavu* is an adaptation of Fo's *Accidental Death of an Anarchist*. *Project S.T.R.I.P* is a hilarious production from Mumbai written by Ram Ganesh Kamatham and directed by Quasar Thakore Padamsee. Swanand Kirkire's musical based on *The Fantasticks* will close the festival with *Aao Sathi Sapna Dekhe*. With the special laughter food festival at the cafe, the audience is sure to giggle all the way home. Stretch your facial muscles.



A STILL FROM PROJECT S.T.R.I.P

Watch Out For

- Prakash Damle in *Olakh Naa Paalakh*, a legend in Marathi Theatre.
- Gulshan Devaiah in *Project S.T.R.I.P*. The Bangalore-based actor who moved to Mumbai rocks the stage in the show.
- The fabulous music and action in Swanand Kirkire's *Aao Saathi Sapna Dekhe*.
- Kavi Sammelan in Hindi and Kannada.
- Sadanand Menon's much sought after arts and theatre workshop.

by Nirmla Ravindran

IF YOU HAVE 60 MINUTES, take a look at the art exhibition Indian Life and Landscape by Western Artists. Till December 6 at NGMA, Delhi.

FESTIVAL

Culture Mix

BHASKAR PAUL/www.indiatodayimages.com



The three-day music and dance festival, Andhri, by Natya Tarangini presents the Parampara series from November 13 to 15 at Ravindra Bharathi, Hyderabad.

◀ **NIRUPAMA, 28 & RAJENDRA, 34** The Bangalore-based Kathak duo are known for their blend of traditional and creative movements. Keeping Kathak as the base, they have explored various themes. Watch out for their brilliant choreographies, traditional yet modern in approach.

ASHWINI BHIDE, 48 She carries the tradition of the famous Jaipur Atrauli Gharana of the Hindustani classical music. Bhide does not merely sing the grammar of the raga but makes one experience the aesthetic *bhava* as well. She is equally proficient in devotional music.

by Amarnath K. Menon



ART EXHIBITION

Colourful Tribute



A WORK ON DISPLAY

What An exhibition titled "Remembering Paritosh Sen".

Who Friends and contemporaries pay tribute to the late iconic artist with paintings and sculptors depicting Sen's portraits.

When and where From November 6 till 14 at Akar Prakar Gallery in Kolkata.

by Elora Sen